> in global short supply and are effectively in the ‘seller’s market’. There are also variations in specifications within the same category of item and hence, price differences which may sometimes reflect differences in specifications or quality. With the shutting down of international flights and surface transport routes, international procurement may have to be done through Indian missions. Being a national health emergency of unprecedented and historic scale, delays in procurement will result in loss of lives of citizens. Hence, there is a paramount public interest in ensuring that the necessary supplies are procured in the fastest possible manner and financial procedures have to adapt accordingly.

Owing to this GoI notification, the empowered group on ‘Ensuring Availability of Essential Medical Equipment such as PPE, masks, gloves and ventilators; production, procurement, import and distribution’ was able to confidently procure ₹30,000 crore worth of lifesaving essentials like medicines, masks, PPEs, testing kits and so on in a matter of weeks.